- Should never use a tasting spoon twice
- Follow hygienic practices while transporting and storing
- Should use sanitary plastic disposable gloves while serving food
- Should clean equipment before and after use



5.2 Food Adulteration

Food Safety and Standard Authority of India (FSSAI) defines food adulteration as the addition or subtraction of any substance to or from the food, so that the natural composition and the quality of food substance is affected.

One form of adulteration is an addition of another substance to a food item in order to increase the quantity of the food item in raw form or prepared form which may result in the loss of actual quality of food item.

Reasons for food adulteration: Adulterants are added to increase the weight and get more profit.

Adulterants

An adulterant is any material which is or could be employed for making the food unsafe or sub-standard or mis-branded or containing extraneous matter (FSSAI, 2006).

Concept of Adulteration

Food is adulterated

- If the food contains any other substance which affects the quality or health of the consumer.
- If the food has been prepared, packed or kept under unsanitary conditions whereby it has become contaminated or injurious to health.
- If the food consists wholly or in part of any filthy, putrefied, rotten decomposed or diseased animal or vegetable substance or is insect infested or is otherwise unfit for human consumption.
- If any colouring matter other than that prescribed in respect thereof is present in the article or if the amounts of the prescribed colouring matter which is present in the article are not within the prescribed limits.

Types of Adulterants: Adulteration may be intentional or incidental.

Intentional adulterants:

Intentional adulterants are those substances that are added as a deliberate act on the part of the adulterer with the intention to increase the margin of profit. Some intentional adulterants are sand, marble chips, stones, mud, chalk powder, water, mineral oil and coal tar dyes. These adulterants cause harmful effects on the body.

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